name, or a wildcard (a file system "glob" pattern). For example, to include all Ruby files whose names start with main, along with the file constants.rb, you could use a .document file containing this:

```
main*.rb
constants.rb
```

Some project standards ask for documentation in a top-level README file. You may find it convenient to write this file in RDoc format and then use the :include: directive to incorporate the README into the documentation for the main class.

RDoc has a lot of command line options for how the output is generated and styled that you will likely use approximately never, use the command rdoc --help for a full rundown.

### Using RDoc to Create Documentation for ri

RDoc is also used to create documentation that will be later displayed using ri or by the irb inline documentation.

When you run ri, it by default looks for documentation in three places:

- The *system* documentation directory, which holds the documentation distributed with Ruby and which is created by the Ruby install process
- The *site* directory, which contains sitewide documentation added locally
- The *user* documentation directory, which is stored under the user's own home directory

You can find these three directories using ri --list-doc-dirs.

You can override the directory location using the --op option to RDoc and subsequently using the --doc-dir option with ri.

To add documentation to ri, you need to tell RDoc which output directory to use. For your own use, it's easier to use the --ri option, which installs the documentation into ~/.rdoc:

```
$ rdoc --ri file1.rb file2.rb
```

If you want to install sitewide documentation, use the --ri-site option:

```
$ rdoc --ri-site file1.rb file2.rb
```

The --ri-system option is normally used only to install documentation for Ruby's built-in classes and standard libraries. You can regenerate this documentation from the Ruby source distribution (not from the installed libraries themselves):

```
$ cd ruby source base/lib
$ rdoc --ri-system
```

## Documenting with YARD

YARD (http://yardoc.org) is an extension of RDoc that uses tags to allow you to add metadata to your comments. It then uses the metadata to create more interesting documentation.